LESSON PLAN · FINANCIAL LITERACY (GR 3–5) BEGINNER: MONEY SMART · LEVEL 1

Lesson 4: Project: Plan a Birthday Party on ₹2,000

Module 1 | 45 minutes | Planning a budget | Grades 3–6 · ages 8–11

Objective: Plan a birthday party on ₹2,000 that covers the must-haves, picks nice-to-haves that fit, keeps ₹200 as savings, and present it like a party planner.

Success criteria

- I can list must-haves first and add them up.
- I can work out how much is left for nice-to-haves.
- I can keep savings safe and stay within budget.
- I can present my plan and explain one hard choice.

Key vocabulary

- **must-have**: Something the plan cannot work without.
- **nice-to-have**: Something that makes it better, but is not needed.
- **total**: All the prices added together.
- **savings**: Money you keep and do not spend.
- **over budget**: When your plan costs more than the money you have.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash (lesson video, activities)
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone); a microphone helps for speaking tasks
- Printed worksheet, paper and pencil
- Printed project brief
- Project files: l04_party_planner_sheet.md, l04_teacher_script.md

Timed lesson plan (45 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	Party price guess: teams guess more or less than ₹500 for each item.
4 min	**Watch + brief**	Play the project video and read the brief together. Thumbs check: “Must-haves first, savings safe, then fun?”
4 min	**Live demo**	Wrong way then right way in the party sim; model a 45-second presentation.
8 min	**Plan in pairs**	Breakout pairs: the must-have sort, then the ₹2,000 party budget sim. Pairs agree on one plan.
8 min	**Build the plan sheet**	Each learner fills the party planner, does the final check, and practises the pitch with a partner.

6 min	**Show-and-tell**	Party planner pitches: 4–5 learners present in one minute each (timer on screen).
4 min	**Peer feedback + vote**	Two stars and a wish for a partner; class poll for “best hard choice explained”.
3 min	**Probe**	Over budget! and New situation: the cake price goes up.
3 min	**Submit + exit**	Submit the module project (plan + reflection). Exit ticket.

Unplugged warm-up

Party price guess (5 min): show pictures of party items one by one (cake, samosas, balloons, a magician). Teams hold up guesses on paper: “more or less than ₹500?” Reveal the course prices. Ask: “Which surprised you?” This makes the prices memorable before planning.

Teaching the idea

This is the Module 1 project: children use everything so far (counting, needs and wants, trade-offs and budgets) to plan a ₹2,000 birthday party. The order is the lesson: must-haves first, savings kept aside, then nice-to-haves with what is left. The presentation builds confidence and shows understanding: every child names one hard choice and what they gave up. Keep the party pretend and the amounts identical for everyone, so it is about skill, not about whose family spends more.

Analogy: Planning a party is like packing a school bag: books and lunch go in first, and toys only go in if there is still room.

Live demo: 1) Show the brief: ₹2,000, keep ₹200, ten friends. 2) In the party sim, “get excited” and add the magician and balloon arch first. Show the bar going red before the cake is even in. 3) Reset. Add cake, snacks, drinks and decorations: ₹1,300. Say: “₹700 left, and ₹200 must stay. So ₹500 of fun money.” 4) Think aloud about the magician (₹800, does not fit) versus return gifts and hats (₹400, fits). 5) Present your own plan in 45 seconds as a model, including “I gave up the magician because…”

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What do you buy first in a party plan?	The must-haves: cake, snacks, drinks, decorations.
How much fun money is left after ₹1,300 of must-haves and ₹200 savings?	₹500.
Why does the magician not fit?	It costs ₹800, more than the ₹500 of fun money.
Your plan is over budget. What do you cut?	A nice-to-have, never a must-have or the savings.
What makes a good presentation?	Items and prices, the total, the savings, and one hard choice explained.

Differentiation

Support
Give a half-filled planner with the must-haves already listed. Learners only choose nice-to-haves and do the final check with the teacher.

Stretch
Plan the same party for 15 friends: snacks, drinks and return gifts cost half as much again (snacks ₹600, drinks ₹300, return gifts ₹450). Can it still work with ₹2,000 and ₹200 savings?

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
If something is fun, it is a must-have.	Must-haves are what the party cannot happen without. Fun extras are nice-to-haves.
Savings can be spent if the plan runs short.	Cut a nice-to-have first; savings stay safe.
Close to the budget is good enough.	Even ₹50 over is over budget. Check the total exactly.
A good party needs everything.	A good plan picks favourites. Choosing is the skill.

Assessment

Project rubric (also on the project brief):

Criterion	1 · Beginning	2 · Developing	3 · Secure	4 · Excellent
Needs first	Must-haves are missing	Most must-haves are there	All must-haves are listed with prices	All must-haves with prices, and explains why each is a must-have
Money maths	Totals are missing or wrong	Totals are there with some mistakes	All totals correct and within budget	All totals correct, shown step by step, and checked twice
Savings and choices	No savings kept	Some savings, but less than ₹200	At least ₹200 saved and one choice explained	₹200 or more saved, and a clear trade-off explained with what was given up
Presentation	Did not present	Presented with lots of help	Presented clearly in about one minute	Confident, clear and under one minute, and answered a question

Exit ticket
Your must-haves cost ₹1,300 and you keep ₹200. How much can you spend on nice-to-haves from ₹2,000?

Homework
Show your party plan to a grown-up at home and present it in one minute. Ask them for one star and one wish.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Must-have or nice-to-have for the party? (perform · categorize)

Must-have: Birthday cake, Snacks for the guests, Drinks and water, Simple decorations
Nice-to-have: Magician show, Balloon arch, Return gifts, Music speaker on rent, Party hats

2. The ₹2,000 birthday party (perform · budget sim)

Must buy: 🎂 Birthday cake, 🥟 Snacks: samosas and sandwiches, 🧃 Juice and water, 🎀 Simple decorations · **Keep at least** ₹200. The must-haves cost ₹1,300. Keeping ₹200 leaves ₹500 for nice-to-haves: for example return gifts and hats (₹400), or the speaker and hats (₹350), or the balloon arch and hats (₹450). The magician alone (₹800) does not fit.

3. Party planning steps (perform · ordering)

Order: Write the total budget and the savings you will keep → List the must-haves and their prices → Add up the must-haves → Work out what is left for nice-to-haves → Pick nice-to-haves that fit → Check the final total and present the plan

4. Over budget! (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: Remove a nice-to-have, such as the ₹800 magician, and check the total again

5. New situation: the cake price goes up (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Drop or swap a ₹100 nice-to-have, like the party hats, so savings stay ₹200

6. Module project: my ₹2,000 birthday party plan (probe · project)

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** must-have = Something the plan cannot work without. · nice-to-have = Something that makes it better, but is not needed. · total = All the prices added together. · savings = Money you keep and do not spend.
2. **Must-have or nice-to-have for the party?:** Must-have: Birthday cake, Snacks for the guests, Drinks and water, Simple decorations · Nice-to-have: Magician show, Balloon arch, Return gifts, Music speaker on rent, Party hats
3. **The ₹2,000 birthday party:** Must buy: 🎂 Birthday cake, 🥟 Snacks: samosas and sandwiches, 🧃 Juice and water, 🎀 Simple decorations. Keep at least ₹200. The must-haves cost ₹1,300. Keeping ₹200 leaves ₹500 for nice-to-haves: for example return gifts and hats (₹400), or the speaker and hats (₹350), or the balloon arch and hats (₹450). The magician alone (₹800) does not fit.

4. **Party planning steps:** 1 Write the total budget and the savings you will keep · 2 List the must-haves and their prices · 3 Add up the must-haves · 4 Work out what is left for nice-to-haves · 5 Pick nice-to-haves that fit · 6 Check the final total and present the plan
5. **Over budget!:** B. Remove a nice-to-have, such as the ₹800 magician, and check the total again — Cut nice-to-haves, never must-haves. Without the ₹800 magician, her plan is ₹1,500, so she keeps ₹500.
6. **My plan:** A clear plan that covers every requirement.
7. **Checklist:** All requirements met.
8. **Two stars and a wish:** Kind, specific feedback and an improvement.

Kitabash original curriculum.